

LocalBuddy — Activity Ideas

300 on-concept experiences for Amsterdam, in three lanes

LocalBuddy isn't a catalogue of bookings — it's a window into how Amsterdammers actually live their week, and a way to be in it with them. Free, open happenings keep the city feeling alive even before anyone pays; the paid experiences are a local's own version of their city; and the "just hang out" lane is the part no generic booking site has. The three groups below are content buckets you can build the product around.

Note: "free experiences" are not yet a backend feature — supporting RSVP-able / info-only free listings is a product addition to plan for.

1 · Free & open · Happening all over Amsterdam

Free, open-to-everyone happenings. On the platform they're either RSVP-able ("I'm going", so a host knows numbers) or simply surfaced as info ("this is on, come by"). Not a private or shared paid slot — just the city's living social calendar.

100 ideas

1. **Sunday morning canal litter pick-up** — kayak and grabber crew on the grachten
2. **Free tip walk through the Jordaan** — local stories, no script
3. **Vondelpark Open-Air Theatre** — free summer concerts and acrobatics
4. **Dawn chorus birdwatch in the Amsterdamse Bos** — bring binoculars
5. **NDSM Saturday flea market wander** — meet at the ferry
6. **Noorderkerk antiques and farmers market** — early Saturday in the Jordaan
7. **Albert Cuypmarkt slow stroll** — De Pijp's everyday street life
8. **Westerpark Sunday Market browse** — makers, vinyl and vintage
9. **Sloterplas sunrise swim crew** — open-water dip before work
10. **Marineterrein harbour swim meetup** — city-centre saltwater plunge
11. **Sauna and ice-dip evening at the Marineterrein** — Nordic winter ritual
12. **Vondelpark social run** — easy 5k loop, all paces welcome
13. **Sunday gravel-and-canal bike ramble out to Waterland**
14. **Friday Night Skate** — mass rollerblade through the city
15. **Newcomers welcome borrel in Oost** — coffee for fresh arrivals
16. **Dutch language tafel** — practise over tea in a Javaplein cafe
17. **Expat-meets-local taalcafe in De Pijp** — swap languages weekly
18. **Free Rijksmuseum garden wander** — sculptures and roses, no ticket
19. **First-Wednesday gallery night on the Jordaan art route**
20. **NDSM artist studio open day** — knock on warehouse doors
21. **Free organ recital at the Westerkerk** — Tuesday lunchtime
22. **Conservatorium student lunch concert** — free seats, world-class playing
23. **OBA central library rooftop view** — free panorama over the IJ
24. **Open-mic night at a Westerpark cafe** — bring a poem or a song
25. **Community potluck in Oostpark** — bring a dish, share a table
26. **Repair Cafe afternoon** — fix your bike, toaster or jeans together
27. **Weggeefwinkel give-away shop visit** — take and leave for free
28. **Buurtmoestuin community garden workday** — dig, plant, weed together
29. **King's Day vrijmarkt browse** — kids selling toys on the stoep
30. **King's Night free street music crawl through the Jordaan**
31. **Pride canal-side viewing spot** — watch the boat parade for free
32. **Milkshake-free Westerpark queer picnic** — sunny LGBTQ+ gathering
33. **Amsterdam Light Festival self-guided canal walk** — winter art trail
34. **Museumnacht-eve free preview borrel** — sneak the late-night vibe
35. **Grachtenfestival free classical pop-up on a canal bridge**
36. **Open Tower Day climb** — free church-tower views, summer only
37. **Open Monument Day** — hidden hofjes and historic houses, free entry
38. **Hortus winter-garden free open afternoon** — tropical warmth in January
39. **Frozen-canal skating when the ice holds** — locals' rare winter joy
40. **Bospop free folk session** — fiddles and beers in the Bos
41. **Oosterpark Roots open-stage afternoon** — world music, no cover
42. **Bimhuis free jazz foyer session** — Tuesday early evening
43. **NDSM open-air film screening** — bring a blanket and a thermos

44. **Pluk de Nacht free outdoor film festival** — Stenen Hoofd harbour
45. **De Hallen indoor market wander** — Oud-West food and makers
46. **Pekmarkt browse on the Van der Pekstraat** — Noord's neighbourly market
47. **Dappermarkt walk in Oost** — multicultural produce and chatter
48. **Ten Katemarkt browse in Oud-West** — fresh stalls, low prices
49. **Lindengracht Saturday market** — Jordaan's friendliest stalls
50. **Plant-swap meetup in Westerpark** — bring a cutting, take one home
51. **Free yoga in the park** — Sunday flow on Museumplein lawn
52. **Outdoor bootcamp crew in the Amsterdamse Bos** — free Saturday sweat
53. **Cold-water Wim Hof breathwork by the Sloterpas** — sunrise group
54. **Beach-clean and dip at Blijburg** — IJburg's urban beach crew
55. **Stadsstrand sunset hang at the NDSM beach** — driftwood and DJs
56. **Free salsa social on the Nieuwmarkt** — open-air summer dancing
57. **Tango milonga under the Magere Brug** — free riverside dancing
58. **Lindy-hop swing night in a Westergas hall** — beginners welcome
59. **Board-game cafe open table** — find players, no entry fee
60. **Chess in the park at the Max Euweplein giant board**
61. **Newcomers' bike-buddy ride** — learn the city's cycling code
62. **Volunteer at the Voedselbank sorting hall** — pack food parcels
63. **Beach-grass dune planting day at the coast** — free conservation outing
64. **Buurtcamping weekend in a city park** — tents on the grass, all free
65. **Iftar community table in De Baarsjes** — open to all during Ramadan
66. **Christmas-market wander at the Westergas** — twinkle lights, free entry
67. **Sinterklaas arrival parade viewing** — kids and pepernoten by the IJ
68. **New Year's Day Nieuwjaarsduik plunge at a city beach**
69. **Carnaval-of-cultures parade watch in the Bijlmer**
70. **Kwakoe-style summer festival in Zuidoost** — free food stalls and music
71. **Free walking food-history tour of the Jordaan's old shops**
72. **Squat-history walking tour** — Amsterdam's alternative past, tip-based
73. **Street-art hunt in Noord** — find the murals on foot
74. **Photowalk golden hour along the Brouwersgracht** — share your shots
75. **Urban-sketching meetup at the Begijnhof** — bring a pad
76. **Knit-and-natter circle in an Oud-West cafe** — yarn and gossip
77. **Death Cafe conversation evening** — frank talk over coffee, free
78. **Silent book club in the OBA** — read together, chat after
79. **Free philosophy debate night at a Centrum bruin cafe**
80. **Stamtafel regulars' table** — drop in and meet the neighbourhood
81. **Community choir open rehearsal in a Jordaan church**
82. **Drum circle at sunset on the Nieuwe Meer shore**
83. **Free zine-making workshop at a Noord cultural squat**
84. **Bike-repair learn-along at a community workshop in Oost**
85. **Free Dutch genealogy help desk at the Stadsarchief**
86. **Beekeeping open hive afternoon on a city rooftop garden**
87. **Foraging walk in the Amsterdamse Bos** — wild herbs with a local
88. **Mushroom-spotting autumn ramble in the Bos** — bring a basket
89. **Stargazing night at the Sloterpas** — away from the city glow
90. **Free wheel-of-light Ferris views from the EYE waterfront lawn**
91. **Sunday morning park parkrun** — timed free 5k, volunteer-run
92. **Open frisbee and kubb on the Museumplein grass** — pick-up games

- 93. Pétanque jeu de boules afternoon in Westerpark** — locals welcome
- 94. Outdoor table-tennis tournament at a Oost playground**
- 95. Free comedy open-mic in a De Pijp basement bar**
- 96. Poetry slam open floor at a Westergas cafe** — sign up at the door
- 97. Vinyl listening night** — bring a record to a Noord bar
- 98. Community film-and-falafel night at a Bijlmer culture house**
- 99. Wadlopen-prep walk along the IJ shore** — mudflat hikers' meetup
- 100. Hofjes garden open afternoon** — peek inside the Jordaan's courtyards

2 · Paid hosted experiences · Shared seat in a small group, or a private buy-out

Curated paid experiences a verified local hosts — booked as a per-person seat in a small group or as a private whole-slot buy-out. Always the local's own version, never a generic coach-tour.

100 ideas

1. **Canalside Indonesian rijsttafel** — at a Surinamese-Javanese grandma's table
2. **Jordaan brown-café crawl** — three regulars, three bittergarnituur stops
3. **De Pijp Albert Cuyp market breakfast** — stroopwafel iron to herring
4. **Private houseboat dinner buyout** — eight seats on my own boat
5. **Noord ferry-and-foraging walk** — wild greens along the IJ
6. **Sunrise sloep on the canals** — coffee, thermos, no other boats
7. **Westerpark natural-wine tasting** — small Dutch growers only
8. **Oud-West cheese-aging cellar visit** — taste straight from the wheel
9. **Javaplein Moluccan spice cooking class** — my family's sambal recipe
10. **Klaverstraat-free shopping walk** — vintage and concept stores locals use
11. **Amsterdamse Bos canoe-and-swim afternoon** — secret reedy inlets
12. **NDSM street-art studio tour** — meet the muralists at work
13. **Jenever distillery tasting in a hidden Centrum cellar** — old genever styles
14. **De Hallen food-makers tour** — behind the counters with the chefs
15. **Private candlelit organ recital** — a tiny canal-house church
16. **Oostpark Turkish-Surinamese supper club** — neighbours cook together
17. **Bike-repair-and-ride workshop** — fix it, then tour like a local
18. **Queer Amsterdam history walk** — Reguliersdwarsstraat past and present
19. **Zuid Amsterdam School architecture walk** — De Dageraad up close
20. **Frietje-and-fritessaus tasting flight** — the city's best loose fries
21. **Canal-house attic history tour** — hidden hoist beams and stories
22. **Pottery wheel evening with a Noord ceramicist** — make your own bowl
23. **Herring-and-genever ritual** — eat it the proper Dutch way
24. **Sloterplas wild-swim and sauna morning** — with a cold-water club
25. **Private whisky-and-cheese pairing** — eight friends, one buyout slot
26. **Westergas Sunday vinyl-and-coffee session** — crate-dig with a DJ
27. **Bakfiets family city ride** — kids in the box, ice cream stops
28. **Tulip-season flower-arranging class** — beyond the bouquet stalls
29. **Jordaan accordion-and-singing night** — a real volkslied levenslied evening
30. **Brouwerij 't IJ windmill beer tasting** — under the De Gooyer mill
31. **Indo-Dutch night market food tour** — pasar-malam flavours year round
32. **Letterpress printing workshop** — set type in a working print shop
33. **Canal swim safety-and-spots tour** — where locals actually dive in
34. **De Pijp coffee-roastery cupping** — taste origins with the roaster
35. **Private rooftop apéro buyout** — a hidden Centrum terrace, six seats
36. **Oost Ethiopian coffee ceremony** — roasted, brewed, shared slowly
37. **Amsterdam Noord allotment-garden lunch** — pick it, then eat it
38. **Bridge-and-lock keeper's walk** — how the canals actually work
39. **Vintage bike restoration afternoon** — rebuild an old omafiets
40. **Westerpark cyanotype photo workshop** — blueprints of the city
41. **Stroopwafel-from-scratch class** — caramel pressed in a hot iron
42. **Private comedy living-room show** — local stand-ups, eight guests

43. **Sephardic Jewish quarter food-and-history walk** — Portuguese synagogue stop
44. **Amstel rowing taster** — learn to scull with a local club
45. **Borrel-and-bitterballen masterclass** — fry your own, pour the genever
46. **Noord industrial-design studio crawl** — meet the furniture makers
47. **King's Day insider route** — vrijmarkt treasure-hunting with a local
48. **Autumn Light Festival canal cruise** — my own small boat, no crowds
49. **Winter ice-skating on a frozen polder** — when the canals freeze
50. **Sauna-and-plunge evening at a local badhuis** — Dutch wellness ritual
51. **De Pijp tapas-and-tale crawl** — Spanish-Amsterdam corners
52. **Private chef's-table dinner** — five courses in my Jordaan kitchen
53. **Oud-West natural-dye textile workshop** — colour from kitchen scraps
54. **Canal-side birdwatching paddle** — herons, coots and city wildlife
55. **Bloemenmarkt-to-vase tulip morning** — choose bulbs and stems
56. **Amsterdamse Bos mushroom forage** — autumn fungi with a mycologist
57. **Javastraat multicultural supper crawl** — five kitchens, one street
58. **Vintage synth-and-record studio session** — make a track, take it home
59. **Westergas circus-skills taster** — juggling and aerial with performers
60. **Private wine-and-art evening** — paint while you sip, six seats
61. **Noord coffee-and-bakery bike loop** — the IJ-side hidden cafés
62. **Centrum hidden-courtyard hofjes walk** — the city's quiet almshouses
63. **Dutch apple-pie baking afternoon** — the proper appeltaart, no shortcuts
64. **Oostpark Surinamese roti class** — fold, fill and fry
65. **Sloep-and-swim summer buyout** — eight friends, boat plus picnic
66. **Genever-cocktail evening** — modern drinks from old Dutch spirits
67. **Amstelveen Japanese-garden tea walk** — matcha and quiet design
68. **De Hallen film-and-falafel night** — arthouse cinema, local bites
69. **Private salsa house-party lesson** — living-room dancing, eight guests
70. **Westerpark fermentation workshop** — kimchi and kombucha with a maker
71. **Canal-house antiques hunt** — vintage dealers locals trust
72. **Noord skate-and-coffee session** — NDSM ramps with a local crew
73. **Amsterdam School stained-glass workshop** — cut and lead your panel
74. **Bike-picnic to the windmills of Zaanse** — countryside escape ride
75. **De Pijp wine-bar lock-in** — natural pours after closing, six seats
76. **Oost Moroccan tea-and-pastry afternoon** — mint tea poured high
77. **Private kids' pancake-boat trip** — poffertjes on the water
78. **Jordaan jewellery-soldering class** — make a silver ring
79. **Westerpark birding-and-brunch** — dawn chorus then coffee
80. **Cheese-and-charcuterie barge buyout** — floating board for eight
81. **Noord brewery-and-bread pairing** — beer with sourdough makers
82. **Centrum nighttime architecture-lights walk** — gables after dark
83. **Amstel sunset SUP session** — paddleboard the quiet outer canals
84. **De Pijp queer cabaret living-room night** — local performers, eight seats
85. **Vintage Vespa city tour** — ride pillion through hidden lanes
86. **Westergas screen-printing workshop** — print your own tote
87. **Oud-West spice-shop cooking class** — Middle-Eastern home dishes
88. **Private high-tea on a saloon boat** — proper Dutch hapjes, six seats
89. **Noord ceramic raku-firing afternoon** — pull pots from the flames
90. **Amsterdamse Bos cold-water swim club** — guided plunge and warm-up
91. **Jordaan oil-painting plein-air session** — canals on canvas

- 92. De Wallen hidden-history walk** — beguines and medieval Amsterdam, no clichés
- 93. Westerpark kids' nature-craft morning** — dens, leaves and pond-dipping
- 94. Private gin-distilling masterclass** — blend your own bottle, eight seats
- 95. Oost Eritrean injera supper club** — communal plate, shared hands
- 96. Noord wood-carving workshop** — make a spoon by hand
- 97. Centrum jazz-cellar session** — intimate set in a canal-house basement
- 98. Amstelpark glassblowing taster** — shape molten glass with a maker
- 99. Private sauna-raft evening on the IJ** — heat, plunge, eight friends
- 100. Private canal-house wine and cheese evening** — your group only, candlelit

3 · Just hang out · One-off, social, low-commitment — company, not a tour

The differentiator. No itinerary, no “tour” — just company and connection. Short, cheap-or-free, identity-light (“a local”, not a “guide”). This is the lane that turns a transaction into a friendship.

100 ideas

1. Morning flat white in De Pijp — coffee chat with a local
2. Be my plus-one to a Jordaan housewarming
3. Shadow my Saturday market run at Noordermarkt
4. Canal-side beer at a brown café in Centrum
5. Who's out tonight? — same-evening Oost meetup
6. Sunset hang on the IJ ferry deck, Noord
7. Co-work morning in a Westerpark café
8. Borrel after work with my colleagues, Zuid
9. Solo-traveller welcome drink near Centraal
10. Lazy Sunday terrace crawl in De Pijp
11. Run buddy loop around Vondelpark
12. Cycle-and-chat to Amsterdamse Bos
13. Climb session at a Noord bouldering gym
14. Wild swim and float at Sloterpas
15. Dog walk through Westerpark with my pup
16. Game night at my place in Oud-West
17. Pub quiz tag-along in Oost
18. Newcomer's first-week orientation pint
19. Queer-friendly café hang in the Reguliers area
20. Vegan potluck dinner with my flatmates
21. Shared table dinner at a Javaplein eetcafé
22. Picnic and frisbee at Oosterpark
23. Thrift-and-coffee afternoon in the Jordaan
24. Sketch-and-sip drawing hour by the canals
25. Vinyl listening session at my Noord loft
26. Late-night fries debrief after a gig
27. Cheese-and-wine evening on a houseboat
28. Sunrise coffee on the Pijp rooftop
29. Be my gym buddy in Zuid this week
30. Saturday morning sauna ritual, Noord
31. Winter glühwein wander at a Christmas market
32. King's Day flea-market browse with a local
33. Pride season terrace hang in Centrum
34. Light Festival canal-side stroll and warm drink
35. Autumn-leaves walk through Amsterdamse Bos
36. First-snow hot-chocolate hang in Westerpark
37. Ice-skating loop when the canals freeze
38. Spring blossom picnic in Beatrixpark
39. Students' cheap-eats dinner near Roeterseiland
40. Creatives' coffee co-work at NDSM
41. Makers' tinker night in a Noord studio
42. Foodies' hidden-snackbar tour-free hang

43. Families' playground meetup in Oost
44. Sporty sunrise bootcamp at Slotterplas
45. Expat language-exchange over beers
46. Board games and bitterballen in the Jordaan
47. Pet-cat cuddle afternoon at my apartment
48. Houseplant swap and tea in De Pijp
49. Open-mic night plus-one in Centrum
50. Watch the football with locals at a café
51. Knit-and-natter circle in Oud-West
52. Book-club drinks for visitors, Zuid
53. Photo-walk golden hour along the Amstel
54. Stroopwafel and coffee stoop hang
55. Karaoke night with my friends in Oost
56. Tag along to my pottery class social
57. Beer garden afternoon at Brouwerij 't IJ
58. Bike repair-and-banter at my kitchen table
59. Skate session at the Noord skatepark
60. Paddleboard morning on the canals
61. Quiet co-reading hour in a Centrum library café
62. Bring-your-own-record DJ hang in Noord
63. Newcomers' bike-buying buddy afternoon
64. Sunday roast at my place in Oud-West
65. Late terrace nightcap before last tram
66. Morning jog plus stretch by the Amstel
67. Wednesday market lunch in De Pijp
68. Crochet and coffee for solo travellers
69. Trivia and tapas evening in Zuid
70. Meet my regulars at the Jordaan brown café
71. Sunset cycle to the windmill at Sloten
72. Slow breakfast and gossip in Oost
73. Tea ceremony chill at my Noord studio
74. Birthday borrel — be a friendly face
75. After-yoga smoothie hang in Oud-West
76. Watch a Dutch film and translate-along
77. Cosy fireplace café afternoon in winter
78. Beach-day trip vibe at Blijburg, Oost
79. Feed-the-ducks and coffee in Sarphatipark
80. Volunteer-shift tag-along then drinks
81. Rooftop apéro at a Zuid friend's place
82. Lantern-lit autumn walk through the Jordaan
83. Cold-plunge and sauna pair at Noord
84. Saturday flower-market amble in Centrum
85. Comedy-night plus-one in Oost
86. Sunday morning swim at Marineterrein
87. Snack-and-stroll Surinamese bite in De Pijp
88. Be my dinner-party guest in Westerpark
89. Casual chess in the park, Centrum
90. Wine bar low-key catch-up in Oud-West
91. Cargo-bike adventure and picnic with my kids

- 92. Sunset rooftop yoga then chill, Noord**
- 93. Late café working session for freelancers**
- 94. Borrel-hop three Jordaan bars with locals**
- 95. Quiet drawing date at the Rijksmuseum gardens**
- 96. Pancake brunch with my flatmates, Oost**
- 97. Midweek dancing-no-tickets night in Centrum**
- 98. Bring-a-dish supper club for newcomers**
- 99. Evening canal swim with the brave locals**
- 100. Lazy hammock hang at Amsterdamse Bos**